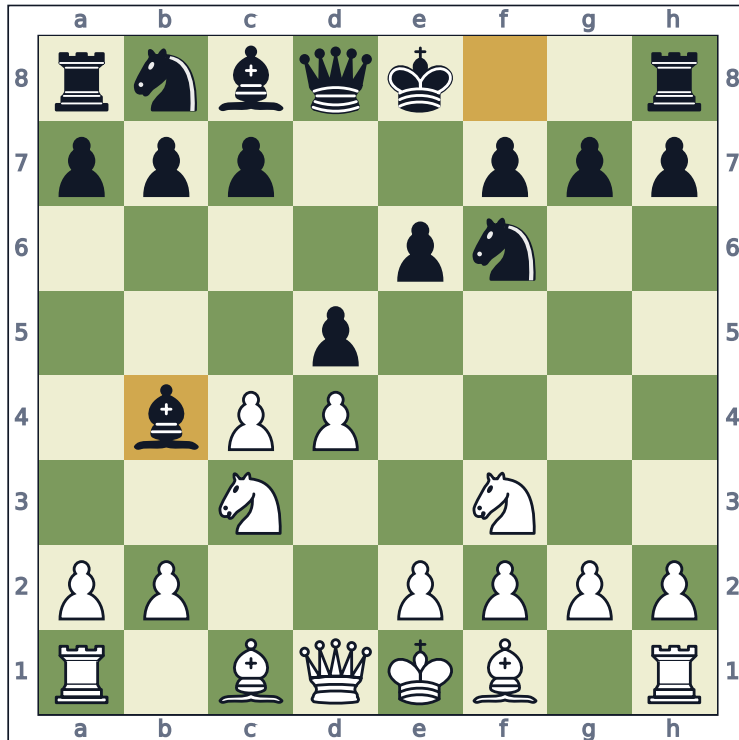


QUEEN'S GAMBIT STRUCTURES

Queen's Gambit Declined

ECO D38 | 3 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.38 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Sharp and concrete: initiative, development, and king safety outweigh routine positional rules.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

D38 covers Queen's Gambit Declined. White uses c4 to challenge Black's d5 pawn and seeks lasting central or queenside pressure. The diagram uses the featured line Queen's Gambit Declined: Ragozin Defense.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. Nc3 Bb4

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Recover or transform the c-pawn investment, complete development, and choose between a central break and minority play.

BLACK'S GOALS

Maintain a sound d5 point, free the c8 bishop, and seek ...c5 or ...e5 before passivity sets in.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

Black's ...c5 and ...e5 are freeing breaks; White commonly uses e4, cxd5, or b4-b5 in minority structures.

PIECE MAP

The c-file, d-file, and minority-attack squares matter. Bishops often improve after central exchanges. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Holding an extra c4 pawn can cost too much development; returning it at the right moment is often best. A gambit is a tactical contract: the sacrificed material must buy concrete time, lines, or targets.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

White moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on c4, White pawn on d4, Black pawn on d5, Black pawn on e6.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

One of chess's most reliable and educational opening complexes, sound at every level.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named D38 line

This section preserves all 3 names and defining routes assigned to D38 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Queen's Gambit Declined: Ragozin Defense

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. Nc3 Bb4

002 Queen's Gambit Declined: Ragozin Defense, Alekhine Variation

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. Nc3 Bb4 5. Qa4+

003 Queen's Gambit Declined: Westphalian Variation

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. Nc3 Bb4 5. Bg5 Nbd7 6. e3 c5